

Final Project Proposal

Overview

For my final project I will be working solo. I see to analyze public lobbying data from the New York State Coalition on Ethics and Lobbying in Government (COELIG) to understand which interests have been lobbying Julie Menon, the current New York City Council Speaker, and on what issue areas. Menon was elected speaker in 2026, largely on a platform of checking Mayor Mamdani's progressive agenda, making her a critical political figure for status quo and established interests seeking to counter his grassroots platform. By examining lobbying records from November 2025 onwards, I aim to identify the interests hiring lobbying firms to engage with Menon and map the issue areas they're focused on. The project will involve text mining to clean and process the lobbying data, followed by network analysis to visualize the connections between these interests, their issue focus, and Menon's position. A key area of uncertainty is data availability for 2026, which I'll need to verify as part of my research process.

Data Sources

The following are URLs to the pages that outline information on the datasets being used. This may expand or shift as the project progresses:

- Lobbyist Bi-Monthly Reports (2025)
 - o https://data.ny.gov/Transparency/Lobbyist-Bi-Monthly-Reports-2025/kn4r-wkd3/about_data
- Lobbyist Bi-Monthly Reports: Beginning 2019
 - o https://data.ny.gov/Transparency/Lobbyist-Bi-Monthly-Reports-Beginning-2019/t9kf-dqbc/about_data
- Lobbyist Statement of Registration: 2025-2026
 - o https://data.ny.gov/Transparency/Lobbyist-Statement-of-Registration-2025-2026/dz6x-9475/about_data
- Client Semi-Annual Report: 2025
 - o https://data.ny.gov/Transparency/Client-Semi-Annual-Report-2025/eqwh-gze7/about_data